# ServiceNow Flow Designer Project

Project Documentation

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| Date | 05.10.2026 |
| Team ID | SWTID-2026-1951 |
| Project Title | Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer |

## 1. Introduction

**Project Title:** Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
**Team ID:** SWTID-2026-1951
**Team Members:**

| S.No | Team Member | Role |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Nancy.D | Team Member |
| 2 | Mythely.J | Team Member |
| 3 | Srimathi.K | Team Member |
| 4 | Sahasri.C | Team Member |

## 2. Project Overview

**Purpose:** Standard laptop requests are often handled by hand through emails and spreadsheets, which causes delays, missed approvals and inconsistent records. This project automates the standard laptop order process on the ServiceNow platform using Flow Designer, so a request moves from submission to fulfilment with minimal manual effort.
**Features:**

- Catalog item for ordering a standard laptop (model, quantity, justification)
- Flow triggered automatically when the request is submitted
- Manager approval step with approve / reject outcomes
- Automatic creation of a procurement / fulfilment task for the IT team
- Email and in-platform notifications to the requester and approver
- Status tracking and an audit trail of every flow execution

## 3. Architecture

**Frontend (Service Portal):** Employees use the Service Catalog on the Service Portal to select the standard laptop item and fill in the order variables.
**Backend (Flow Designer):** A flow runs on the request item. It contains a trigger, actions (Ask for Approval, Create Task, Update Record, Send Email) and conditional logic (If / Else) for the approval result.
**Database (ServiceNow tables):** Requests are stored in the platform's standard tables.

| Table | Purpose |
|---|---|
| sc_request / sc_req_item | Stores the request and the requested laptop item |
| sc_task | Fulfilment task assigned to the procurement team |
| sysapproval_approver | Approval records for the manager |

| Table | Purpose |
|---|---|
| sys_user | Requester and approver details |

**Process Flow Diagram**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Employee submits laptop request** | **Flow Designer trigger fires** | **Manager approval** |
| **Approved?** | **Create fulfilment task / order laptop** | **Notify requester and close** |

Row 1 runs left to right (submit, trigger, approval). The decision in row 2 follows: if approved, a fulfilment task is created and the requester is notified; if rejected, the request is closed and the requester is informed.

## 4. Setup Instructions

**Prerequisites:**

- ServiceNow Personal Developer Instance (PDI) with admin access
- Flow Designer and Service Catalog plugins (active by default)
- A manager user and a requester user for testing

**Installation / Configuration:**

- Sign in to the ServiceNow instance as admin.
- Create the catalog item *Standard Laptop* with variables (model, quantity, justification).
- Open Flow Designer and create a new flow named *Standard Laptop Order*.
- Set the trigger to the Service Catalog request item for this catalog item.
- Add Ask for Approval, If / Else, Create Task, Update Record and Send Email actions.
- Save, test and activate the flow.

## 5. Folder Structure

ServiceNow is configured on the platform, so the equivalent structure is the application scope:

```
Laptop Procurement (application)
  Service Catalog / Catalog Item: Standard Laptop
  Flow Designer / Flow: Standard Laptop Order
  Notifications / Email templates
  Tables / Fulfilment task configuration
```

## 6. Running the Application

- Open the Service Portal and search for *Standard Laptop*.
- Submit the request as the requester.
- Open Flow Designer > Executions to watch the flow run.
- Approve or reject the request as the manager and check the result.

## 7. API Documentation

The solution is built with Flow Designer; the platform's Table API can be used to read the records involved.

| Method | Endpoint | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| GET | /api/now/table/sc_req_item | List requested laptop items |

| Method | Endpoint | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| GET | /api/now/table/sc_task | List fulfilment tasks |
| GET | /api/now/table/sysapproval_approver | List approval records |
| PATCH | /api/now/table/sc_req_item/{sys_id} | Update a request item |

## 8. Authentication

Access is handled by ServiceNow's built-in security. Users sign in with their credentials (or SSO if configured) and a session is created. Roles control what each person can do: the requester can submit requests, the manager can approve, and the procurement team can work on fulfilment tasks. API calls use basic authentication or OAuth tokens.

## 9. User Interface

Planned screens to include: Service Portal catalog page, Standard Laptop order form, Flow Designer canvas, approval screen and notification email. *(Insert screenshots here.)*

## 10. Testing

- Submit a request as a requester and confirm the flow triggers.
- Approve the request and confirm the fulfilment task is created.
- Reject the request and confirm it closes with a notification.
- Review the Flow Designer execution log for each run.

## 11. Screenshots or Demo

*(Add screenshots of the catalog item, flow canvas and execution results, or a link to a demo video.)*

## 12. Known Issues

- Only standard laptop models are covered; custom specifications need manual handling.
- The flow depends on the requester having a manager set on their user record.
- Email notifications require the instance's email settings to be configured.

## 13. Future Enhancements

- Integrate with vendor or inventory systems to place orders automatically
- Add budget-based approval rules for higher-cost requests
- Provide dashboards for order status and turnaround time
- Extend the flow to other standard hardware such as monitors and phones